



ATEN CS52A 2 Port Hybrid KVM

One finger switch your PCs

The ATEN CS52A is a 2 port Hybrid KVM (Keyboard, Video, Mouse) switch targeted at the home user who has more than two machines running—laptop and PC, for example. KVM switches are meant to be used as a way to quickly switch between two computers without virtual networking software.

What you get in the package is three branches of cables—two of which connect to the two machines and a third for the display, keyboard and mouse you'll be using with the two systems. You also get USB and audio connectivity for the speakers and microphone. Unlike more advanced KVMs, there are no security features built into this device.

It seems a little confusing to setup at first, but once done, switching

control from one computer to another is effortless—a press of a button is all it takes. A Quick Guide is provided to help new users get on their way quickly.

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★★
Performance	★★★★★
Build Quality	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★



The build quality is decent and the cables are fairly sturdy as well. The cables are around 4 to 5 feet in length in length and should be sufficient to reach two computers on tables kept side by side.

At Rs. 2750, it's slightly more expensive than expected. We don't really see the need for such a product in a country like India where most households have a single PC. Those using a

laptop and a PC might find this most useful, though.

Specifications

Dimensions: 8.45 x 3.40 x 2.13cm, Weight: 0.41kg

Contact: Cubix Micro Systems

Phone: 022-25008968

E-mail: sales@cubixindia.com

Web site: www.aten.com

Price: Rs 2,750

Linksys NAS200

Not fast enough

The Linksys NAS200 is a small entry-level NAS box, offering decent features at an attractive price, but with a few flaws that are hard to overlook.

The NAS200 looks like double-decker router box and has perforated black plastic all around for ventilation. The hard drive mounting isn't the sturdiest we have seen. Two USB ports are available for external storage to take backups at the press of a button.

Setting up the NAS200 is quite simple and the provided CD makes it even simpler for home users with no networking experience. The hard drives can be configured in RAID 0, RAID 1 and JBOD via a Web interface or the client application. The

Web interface is cryptic and unintuitive.

The NAS200 comes with a media server and devices supporting UPnP can connect and stream multimedia content directly. The device also has a download manager that can download files directly without the need to keep a PC switched on. It supports HTTP and FTP, but we would like to see support for BitTorrent (mid-range NAS boxes have it). The drives can power down if inactive to save electricity.

In these Gigabit Ethernet times, the NAS200 only has an Ethernet port (10/ 100)—unacceptable. In our test, it took around 5 minutes to transfer 1 GB of data when configured as single disk.



Such speeds are good enough for normal file transfers, but when using it as a media server, the impact will be significant.

For the features, the tag of Rs 9990 seems reasonable for normal home use.

RATINGS	
Feature	★★★★★
Performance	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Build Quality	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★

Demanding users wanting media streaming might find the performance poor.

Specifications

Capacity: 512 MB Flash memory, SD expandable slot; Music formats: AAC, MP3, WAV; Dual 3.5 mm audio jacks; Lanyard with aluminium ring

Contact: Linksys India

Phone: NA

E-mail: Linksys_india_sales@cisco.com

Web site: www.linksys.com

Price: Rs 9,990

SanDisk Extreme Ducati Edition 4GB

More oomph than a Ducati

USB drives are boring. The new SanDisk Extreme Ducati Edition is not. Visually appealing and built to resemble a Ducati motorbike, this drive is encased in a solid metal jacket with a red glossy paint job, silver and black details and even a little Ducati badge on top—a delight for any Ducati fan. A taillight that blinks during data transfer is also a nice touch. The metal does make it heavier than most other drives its size, and it's a bit bulkier too.

With excellent build quality and a retractable gold-plated USB connector, it appears ready to take any punishment. A long lanyard

is provided so you can wear it around your neck to prevent it from getting lost, though it becomes uncomfortable to wear this dead weight after a while.

The drive supports ReadyBoost for Vista, and is compatible with Windows Vista, XP, 2000, Mac OS and Linux. There's no file backup, encryption or U3 capability, but the drive exhibits blazing transfer speeds, taking just 34 seconds to transfer a 700 MB

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★★
Performance	★★★★★
Build Quality	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★



file to the drive; transferring it back takes just 29.5 seconds. This is one of the speediest performances by a Flash drive we've seen so far.

SanDisk bundles RescuePRO Deluxe—a data recovery software that can recover files deleted from any drive, specifically meant for memory cards. It is backed by an unmatched lifetime warranty from SanDisk and that makes it a very attractive option for portable data storage and transfer. In both

performance and style, the SanDisk Extreme Ducati Edition assumes pole position and is definitely worth a buy, if you don't mind the slightly steep price.

Specifications

Capacity: 4 GB; Interface: USB 2.0; Lanyard; Weight: 100 gm

Contact: Rashi Peripherals Pvt Ltd

Phone: +91-22-67090820

E-mail: sandisk@rptechindia.com

Web site: www.sandisk.com

Price: Rs 4,200

Western Digital My Book Pro Edition II 2 TB (WDG2TP20000N)

Back up your whole world

First it was the 1 TB drive, but now, Western Digital has upped the ante by sending us an external hard drive, with a size of gargantuan proportions of 2 TB—the My Book Pro Edition II.

Ruggedly constructed, this drive looks like an extra-large reference book. The casing looks like aluminium, but is in fact a strong polymer. The drive has a push-button on one side that lets you take one-touch backup of your data in conjunction with the provided Retrospect backup software. This is a user-serviceable drive—you can take out the two SATA II WD10EACS SE16 drives inside and get them replaced yourself. The drives are configured so that you can either choose RAID mirroring for extra data protection or, RAID striping for speed and performance.

RAID configuration is easy with WD's intuitive RAID Wizard software.

The My Book sports triple interface: USB 2.0, FireWire 400 as well as the ultra-fast FireWire 800 which has a fast throughput of 800 MBps. In fact, there is an extra FireWire 800 port that lets you connect more drives in a daisy-chain, if one fine day, 2 TB does not suffice your ever-growing demands, and the design of the drive lets you stack one drive over another.

Drive performance—though not the best—is as good as we expected. It took about 45 seconds to transfer a sequential file to the drive and 40 to copy it back. Things speed up by about 40 per cent when you use the FireWire 400 interface.

The bundled Retrospect Express backup software can handle all the data backup tasks including encryption. You can schedule these tasks

and it can even do a complete restore of your system if things go horribly wrong. A convection cooling system driven by a thermostatically controlled fan with a rubber frame (to dampen noise) keeps this setup cool. All the necessary data cables are provided, so you don't need to go looking around for them. The My Book is quite bulky,—1.93 Kg, for obvious reasons—and carrying isn't very pleasant. Even with 2 TB, the obscenely expensive price tag of Rs 45,000 will take a bite out of your flesh.

Specifications

2 TB; 2xWD10EACS SE16 SATA II

RATINGS	
Performance	★★★★★
Feature	★★★★★
Build Quality	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★



7,200 rpm hard drives; Latency: 4.2 ms; Read seek time: 8.9 ms; Interfaces: USB 2.0, FireWire 400, and FireWire 800; Cables: USB 2.0, IEEE 1394a, IEEE1394b; Dantz Retrospect Express backup software; Dimensions: 174.6 (H)mm X 159.3 (D)mm X 104 (W)mm; Weight: 1.93 Kg

Contact: Venktron Infotech

Phone: +91-9321029204

E-mail: amarjit.singh@wdc.com

Web site: www.wdc.com

Price: Rs 45,000